A little loyalty. A lot to explore.

Imagine you're the analyst working with a product team at a fictional payment service. People use it to pay online and in shops. The team would love them to keep coming back.

Enter VIP: a free loyalty programme where members earn points when they make purchases. Sounds promising. But is it making a difference?

Your product manager has a few questions:

“Do people who join VIP buy more, the same or less? Does inviting people to join help them keep using us? And what should we do next?”

You've got a year of purchasing data and an invitation experiment to explore. The team hasn't agreed on what “keep coming back” should mean. That's part of the fun - and where you come in.

Follow your curiosity

Help the team decide what matters and what to do next.

Start with the questions you think are worth answering. Follow an interesting lead. Challenge an assumption. If you spot an opportunity beyond the product manager's original questions, go for it.

We'd like to hear what you explored, what you found, and how it shaped your recommendation. There's no hidden answer we're hoping you'll guess.

Pick one or two important areas to explore properly and cover others more lightly. A few useful findings beat a mountain of charts. Tell us what you left for later and why.

You don't need an advanced model, a dashboard or production-ready code. If you see a useful way to make the learning or measurement reusable, we'd love to hear about that too.

Meet VIP and the experiment

VIP has been available since May. It's free to join, members earn points on purchases, and all merchants in this fictional dataset participate. People can find and join the programme themselves. Nobody cancels their membership during the exercise.

The team also ran an invitation experiment. Eligible non-members were randomly assigned to receive one invitation (`invitation`) or no invitation (`control`), roughly half in each group, within blocks of similar June purchase frequency. To qualify, users needed a June purchase and data coverage since January. Existing VIP members weren't included.

An invitation isn't a signup: invited users can say “no thanks”, while control users can join on their own. The timestamp in `experiment_exposure.csv` records assignment for both groups - not an invitation being opened or someone joining VIP.

The experiment started in a summer wave and a smaller December wave. You can only observe what happened up to the year-end cutoff.

Keep the difference between membership associations and invitation effects in mind. You don't need to analyse both exhaustively, but explain what your evidence can - and can't - tell us. Choose measures and time windows that make sense, and show uncertainty where it helps the decision.

Loyalty costs, points redemption and invitation-interaction data aren't available. What else would you want to know before taking the next step?

Bring us the interesting bits

Prepare a **15-20-minute presentation** for a product manager and an analytics colleague. Take us through your most important findings, your reasoning and what you recommend.

No need to show every query or chart. Give us a story we can follow and a recommendation we can discuss. Slides, a notebook, a document - use whatever helps you explain your thinking.

The rest of the interview is a conversation: we'll explore your choices, ask questions and think through what comes next. The overall appointment is 90 minutes, including getting settled and wrapping up.

Allow **2-4 hours, including presentation preparation**, and **stop after four hours**. Really. We're interested in how you prioritise, not how much of your weekend you can give us. Unanswered questions are welcome - tell us where you'd go next.

Bring your AI sidekick, if you like

AI agents and other AI-assisted tools are encouraged, just as they are in our day-to-day work. Use whichever analytical tools suit you.

You're still in the driving seat. Be ready to explain how you directed the work, checked the outputs, and challenged or redirected suggestions. We're interested in the choices you made - not a full chat transcript.

If you have questions before the interview, ask your recruiting contact. We'll share any clarification that materially changes the exercise with everyone taking the same case. If an answer isn't available, make a reasonable assumption and keep going.

A few things to know about the data

This is a fictional exercise using adapted public data and synthetic attributes and activity. It contains no Vipps MobilePay customer or merchant data. Public card purchases stand in for purchases through the fictional service; dates are shifted and values are rescaled to NOK.

`volume_nok` is the purchase value. `revenue_nok` is the amount the fictional payment service retains as a merchant-specific percentage of that value. The rates are fictional and revenue is before costs - not profit.

Users live in Norway or Denmark and can buy from international merchants. All purchase values are already expressed in NOK.

The extract covers **1 January-31 December 2025**, with a common cutoff of **1 January 2026, exclusive**. It includes successful positive purchases, but not failed payments, refunds, transfers or app interactions.

A user's observation start marks the beginning of available purchase data, **not** their registration date. Behaviour before that date is unknown. From that date through the cutoff, all completed purchases through the fictional service are represented.

File	What's inside
`transactions.csv`	Each row represents one completed purchase with a positive transaction value.
`users.csv`	Users, coverage, country, age bucket and VIP membership
`merchants.csv`	Fictional merchants, countries and merchant categories
`mcc.csv`	Merchant category descriptions
`cards.csv`	Cards, owners, types, schemes and status at cutoff - optional
`experiment_exposure.csv`	Invitation experiment assignments

You don't need to use every table. Choose what helps answer your questions; leaving out an irrelevant table won't count against you.

The data dictionary explains the fields and joins. Be ready to talk us through how you checked that your analysis is reliable. Source credit and licence information are included in the accompanying files.

Enjoy exploring. We're looking forward to seeing what catches your eye.